EXP NO: 6 Hotel Booking Automation Suite – Workflow Options in Zoho Creator

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Aim

To design and build an automation layer in Zoho Creator for the "Hotel Room Booking" application, demonstrating the correct usage of the Workflow options available in Zoho Creator – Form Workflows, Schedules, Approvals, Payments, Blueprints, Batch Workflows, Report Workflows and Functions – so that the booking lifecycle runs with minimal manual intervention from enquiry to post-stay follow-up.

Theory

Workflows in Zoho Creator automate business logic without manual effort. They are either event-driven (Form Workflows and Report Workflows, which fire when a record is added, edited or deleted) or time-driven (Schedules and Batch Workflows, which run at a set date, time or frequency). Approvals add a human checkpoint before an action is applied, Blueprints enforce a controlled sequence of stages with role-based transitions, Payments integrate an external payment gateway, and Functions hold reusable Deluge logic that can be called from several places.

In a hotel, many downstream actions depend on a human: sending booking confirmations, reminding guests of upcoming check-ins, approving complimentary upgrades or discounts, collecting advance payments, requesting feedback and recalculating the payable amount. This does not scale in peak season and causes delay and inconsistency. A complete workflow layer on top of the booking form removes this dependency.

Application Details

Item	Details
Application Name	Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management (Hotel Booking Site)
Base Form	EXP 6 (booking form with Booking ID, guest, room type, tariff, discount and payment fields)
Primary Users	Guests (indirect, via automated communication), Front Office, Manager, Finance Team
Deliverable	Automations for each Zoho Creator Workflow option, layered onto the booking process

Workflow Options and Their Mapping

Workflow Option	Workflow Name	Purpose	Trigger / Frequency
Form Workflows	On_Booking_Submit_Workflow	Sends a booking confirmation to the guest and notifies the front office	On successful form submission (Add)
Schedules	Daily_Checkin_Reminder_Schedule	Identifies guests checking in the next day and sends a reminder email	Daily, based on Check-In Date
Approvals	Complimentary_Upgrade_Approval	Routes complimentary upgrades or special discounts to the manager for approval	On review of a flagged booking
Payments	Booking_Advance_Payment_Workflow	Generates a payment link and updates Advance Payment Status	Immediately after form submission
Blueprints	Booking_Lifecycle_Blueprint	Enforces the lifecycle Enquiry → Confirmed → Checked-In → Checked-Out with role-based transitions	Applied to every booking record
Batch Workflows	Bulk_Feedback_Request_Batch	Sends feedback survey links to guests who checked out, in batches	Every night at 11:00 PM
Report Workflows	OnEdit_Recalculate_Balance_Workflow	Recalculates Total Amount Payable when tariff or discount is edited from the report	On Edit of a report record
Functions	Generate_Invoice_Function	Reusable function that generates and emails the stay invoice	On Checked-Out status; manual button

Procedure

Part A – Preparing the booking form

- Open the application “Hotel Booking Site” in Zoho Creator and go to the Design tab.
- Open the form (EXP 6) in the form builder and add the fields needed by the workflows: Booking ID (Auto Number), Guest Name, Room Type, Email Address, Phone Number, Check In Date, Check Out Date, Room Tariff, Discount, Special Discount, Total Amount Payable, Advance Payment Status and Transaction Reference.
- Save the form and confirm that the field link names are correct, since the workflows refer to them.

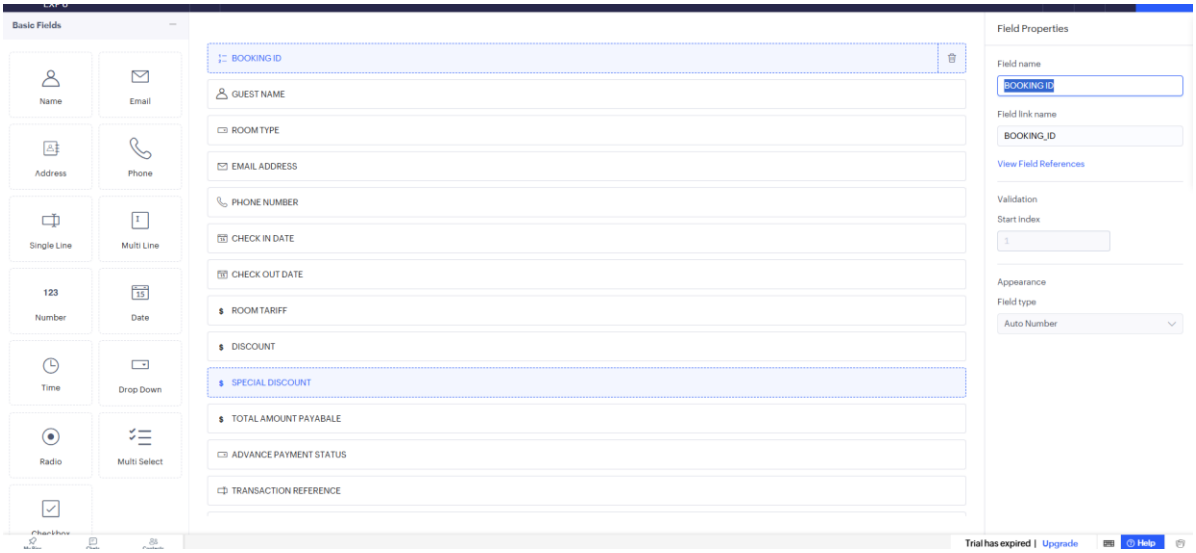


Figure 1: Form builder for the EXP 6 booking form with its fields and field properties

Part B – Creating the workflows

- Open the Workflow tab of the application. The sub-tabs Form workflows, Schedules, Approvals, Payments, Blueprints, Batch workflows and Functions are shown at the top.
- Select the relevant sub-tab, click New Workflow (or New Blueprint / New Batch Workflow) and choose the form.
- Set the trigger, add the required actions (send mail, update records and so on) and save with the specified name.
- Make sure the status toggle shows Enabled, then test with a sample booking.

Implementation of Workflows

1. Form Workflow – On_Booking_Submit_Workflow

This workflow is event-driven. It is configured on the form with the trigger “Created or Edited > Successful form submission” and has one action. When a booking is submitted it sends the guest

a confirmation containing the booking details and notifies the front office. It is created and shown as Enabled.

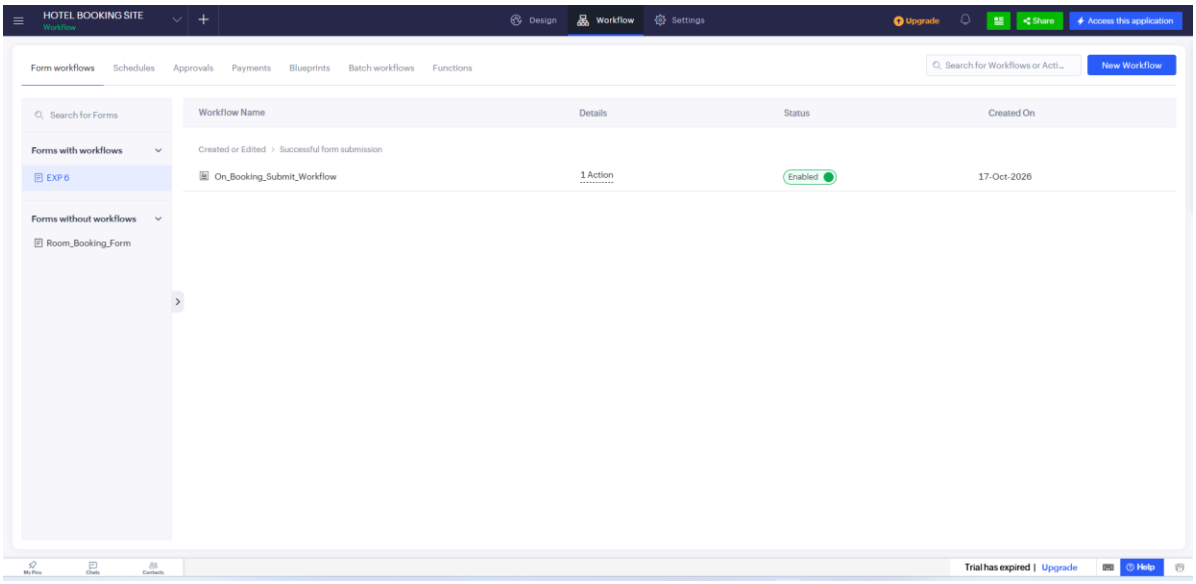


Figure 2: Form workflows – On_Booking_Submit_Workflow (Enabled, 1 action)

2. Schedule – Daily_Checkin_Reminder_Schedule

This workflow is time-driven. It is based on the CHECK IN DATE field and has one action, which sends a reminder email to guests who are checking in the next day, with directions and pre-arrival instructions. In the screenshot the schedule appears as Disabled; enable it before the live run so that it fires automatically.

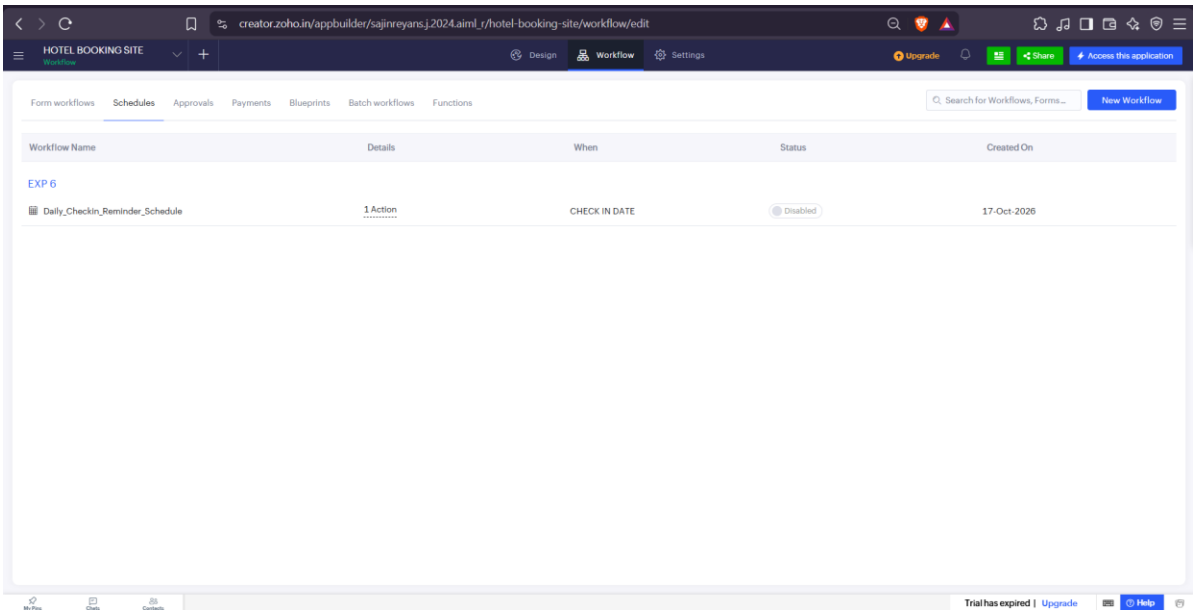


Figure 3: Schedules – Daily_Checkin_Reminder_Schedule

3. Approval – Complimentary_Upgrade_Approval

This workflow adds a human checkpoint. When a booking is flagged for a complimentary upgrade or special discount, it is sent "On review" to the manager. The upgrade or discount is applied only after the approver approves the request. The approval is Enabled and its actions (for example on approve and on reject) are configured under the Details column.

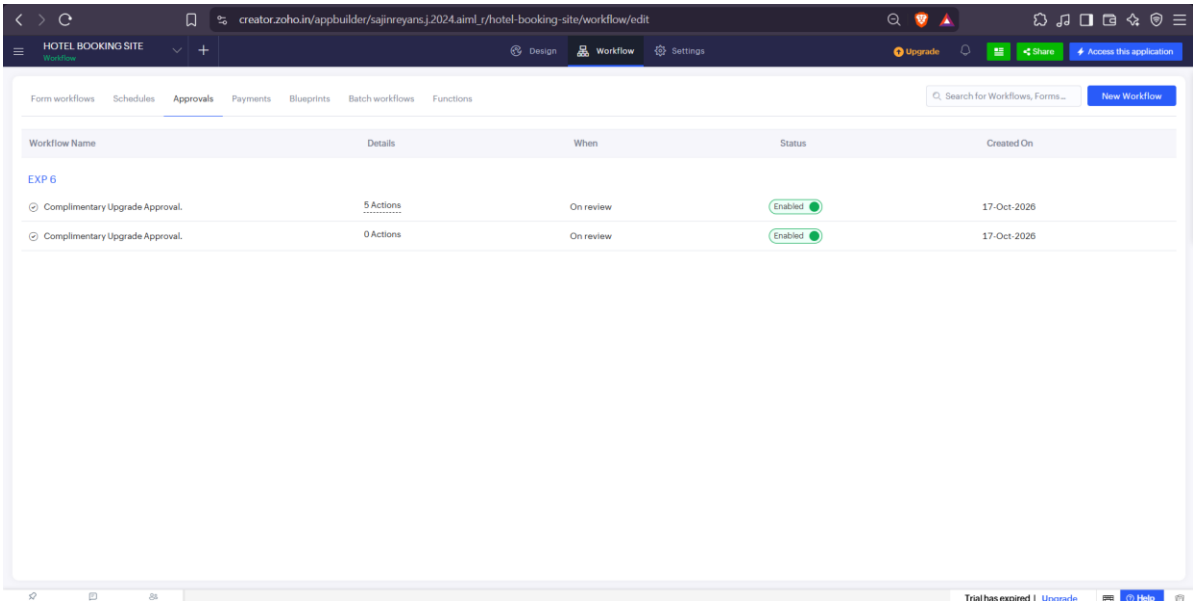


Figure 4: Approvals – Complimentary_Upgrade_Approval (Enabled, On review)

4. Payments – Booking_Advance_Payment_Workflow

The Payments workflow connects a payment gateway to the booking form. It generates a secure payment link for the advance amount, redirects the guest to the gateway, and updates Advance Payment Status and Transaction Reference on success or failure.

[Insert screenshot: Payments tab showing Booking_Advance_Payment_Workflow]

5. Blueprint – Booking_Lifecycle_Blueprint

The Blueprint defines the booking lifecycle as a controlled sequence of stages: Enquiry → Confirmed → Checked-In → Checked-Out. Each transition is limited to specific roles and requires a mandatory comment, so the manager gets an auditable trail of when and by whom each booking moved between stages. The blueprint is created for the form and shown as Enabled.

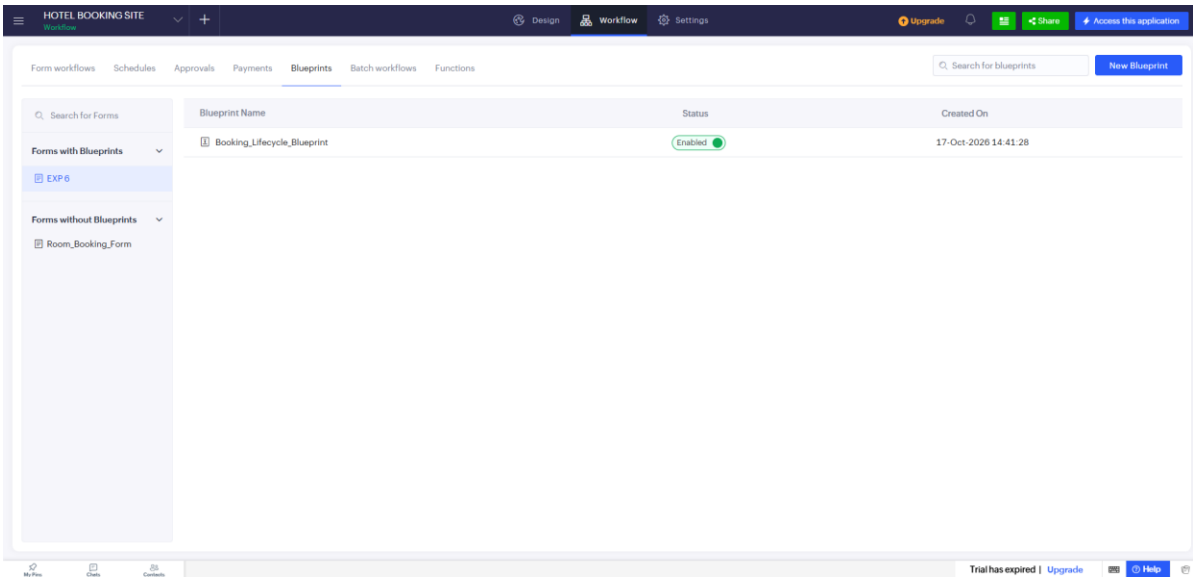


Figure 5: Blueprints – Booking_Lifecycle_Blueprint (Enabled)

[Insert screenshot: Blueprint visual stage diagram with transition permissions]

6. Batch Workflow – Bulk_Feedback_Request_Batch

The Batch Workflow runs on a schedule and processes records in controlled batches rather than all at once. It is triggered every night at 23:00:00 (11:00 PM) and sends a feedback survey link to guests who have checked out. Processing in batches prevents the workflow engine from timing out on a busy check-out day.

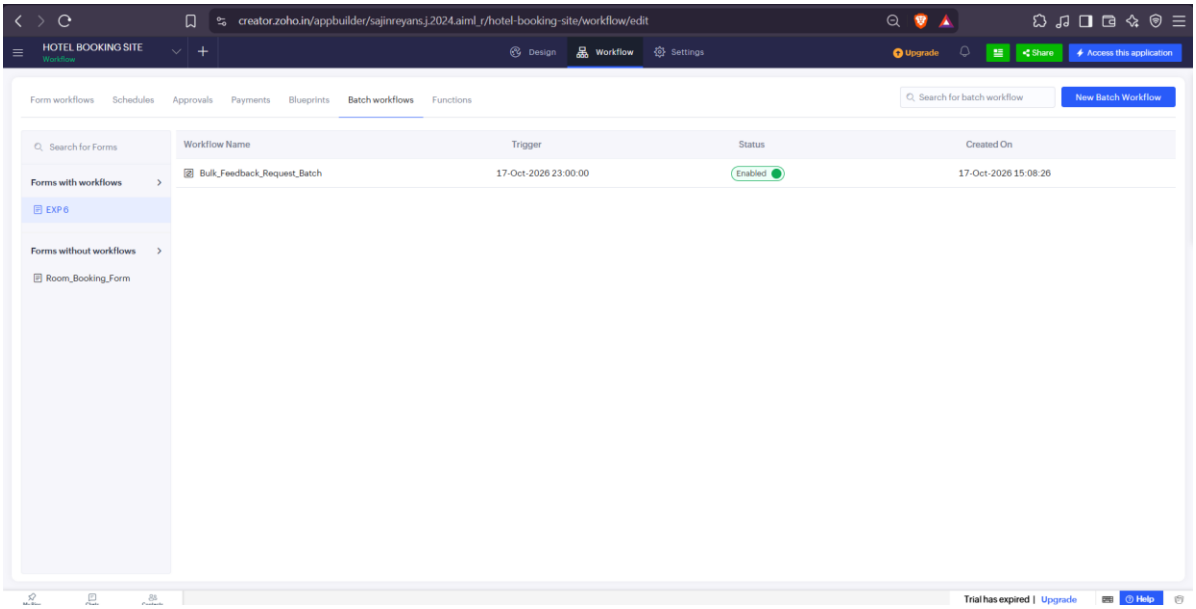


Figure 6: Batch workflows – Bulk_Feedback_Request_Batch (trigger 23:00:00, Enabled)

7. Report Workflow – OnEdit_Recalculate_Balance_Workflow

The Report Workflow fires when staff edit a record directly in the report. It recalculates Total Amount Payable only when Room Tariff or Discount changes, so billing stays accurate without resubmitting the form.

[Insert screenshot: Report workflow OnEdit_Recalculate_Balance_Workflow]

8. Function – Generate_Invoice_Function

The Function is a reusable Deluge script that generates the final stay invoice and emails it to the guest. It validates that Guest Name and Email are present, and can be called automatically when the status becomes Checked-Out and manually through a "Resend Invoice" button.

[Insert screenshot: Deluge script of Generate_Invoice_Function]

[Insert screenshot: Evidence of the function being called from two different workflow types]

Configuration and Governance Rules

- Form Workflow: fails gracefully and logs an error if the guest's email is invalid, instead of blocking the booking.
- Schedule: sends only one reminder per booking.
- Approval: single approver role (Duty Manager) with a fallback approver.
- Payments: retries the gateway status-check callback up to 3 times before marking the transaction as failed.
- Blueprint: every stage transition requires a mandatory comment.
- Batch Workflow: batch size is configurable (default 100 records).
- Report Workflow: fires only when Room Tariff or Discount changes.
- Function: input validation so it fails safely if Guest Name or Email is empty.

End-to-End Workflow Summary

- A guest submits the booking form, which triggers On_Booking_Submit_Workflow to send a confirmation.

- Booking_Advance_Payment_Workflow generates a payment link and updates Advance Payment Status.
- If a booking is flagged for an upgrade or special discount, Complimentary_Upgrade_Approval routes it to the manager.
- The record moves through Booking_Lifecycle_Blueprint stages as staff confirm, check in and check out the guest.
- Each evening Daily_Checkin_Reminder_Schedule emails guests checking in the next day.
- If staff adjust a tariff or discount in the report, OnEdit_Recalculate_Balance_Workflow keeps the payable amount accurate.
- Every night Bulk_Feedback_Request_Batch sends feedback surveys in controlled batches.
- When a guest is marked Checked-Out, Generate_Invoice_Function creates and emails the invoice; it can also be run manually.

Event-Driven vs Time-Driven Automation

Type	Workflow Options	Fires When
Event-driven	Form Workflows, Report Workflows, Payments	A record is added, edited or submitted
Time-driven	Schedules, Batch Workflows	A set date, time or frequency is reached
Controlled process	Approvals, Blueprints	A human decision or stage transition is needed
Reusable logic	Functions	Called from a workflow, button or schedule

Result

Thus, an automation layer was built on the hotel booking application in Zoho Creator using the Workflow options provided by the platform. Form workflows, schedules, approvals, blueprints and batch workflows were created and enabled, so that confirmations, reminders, approvals, controlled stage changes and feedback requests happen automatically. This shows how Zoho Creator's low-code approach reduces manual effort and ensures timely, consistent communication throughout the booking lifecycle.